

around Father did. And if we had, the tough old coot wouldn't have listened to us anyway because he was always ruggedly independent and self-willed.

One of his former Stanford students, Tony Spare, who went on to run the Bank of California's money management operations and then started his own successful money management firm (since sold and a shadow of its former self ), long revered Father. On November 5, 1998, Tony was having a client seminar in San Francisco and asked Father to come deliver a dinner speech. Father left his San Mateo office in the late afternoon to walk to the train station to ride to the city, where he could catch a taxi downtown to Tony's event. Tony would drive him home that night. The walk was wet from the afternoon's light drizzle. As Father passed through downtown San Mateo, he saw the next stop light start-ing to shift from green to yellow and he ran to beat it, something he had done all his life. As he ran off the near curb, he slipped and fell, break-ing his right hip cleanly. The recovery went reasonably well, but from moment one of that trauma, dementia flooded through the opportunity like a dam breaking.

As Father's body recovered, his memory and logic did less so. I was running his health care program and feeling pretty darned good about how well he was improving. But as so often happens with a hipbreak in the elderly, on January 15, 1999, he contracted pneumonia, which hit him hard and almost killed him. By January 19, he was in intensive care, and we were told to expect his death by morning. Mother was very upset. Arthur flew down from Seattle and sat the night with him. By 3 A.M., the tough old coot was pulling through, coming out of the coma and reacting initially to pin pricks to his toes. By 5 A.M., Arthur had me back down there. By 8, I was calling mother, who was already grieving his death, telling her to get back down to meet me because she could once again talk with her husband, who was conscious and clear-eyed, even if he was still on a respirator. I assembled an around-the-clock ded-icated team of nurses and injected them into the hospital with my own doctor's oversight to supervise Father as he came out of intensive care. Hospitals do the best they can with elderly patients, but their care for people in that condition is really totally inadequate; and there isn't much they can do about it because of how they function. And the family was clear that we were going to do better. This particular hospital had never before actually had anyone bring in a dedicated outside crew, but they were very good to me as I put it in place,